



Agent Skills & Tooling

Explore featured tools, discover community contributions from CAT, and learn the standards and practices behind agent skills.

Microsoft-published · 142/146

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Advisor catalog

Catalog generated 21 Sep 2026

98 skills

24 MCP

24 reference

CAT CAT featured highlights

CAT highlights are a curated selection, not a claim of CAT authorship or gallery origin. Actual sources are shown on each card.

Skill Recorder ↗

AUTHOR

Desktop app

Desktop app: record a task, review the Copilot analysis, then generate a reusable Agent Skill or Automation.
microsoft/skill-recorder

Open source · GitHub ↗

MCS Assistant ↗

AUTHOR

Experimental plugin

Experimental plugin for creating, editing, validating and migrating classic Copilot Studio agents to the new experience.
microsoft/copilot-studio-plugin
Experimental classic-to-modern Copilot Studio migration: Experimental plugin for creating, editing, validating, and migrating classic Copilot Studio agents to the new experience.
Copilot Studio Plugin · skill · Author

Open source · GitHub ↗

MCP App UI ↗

AUTHOR

Skill · Generate MCP App UI

Create interactive widgets for MCP tool output.
microsoft/power-platform-skills/plugins/mcp-apps/skills/generate-mcp-app-ui
Power Platform Skills · skill · Author

Skill

Open source · GitHub ↗

More from CAT Community-contributed

Community-contributed · published through the CAT gallery's contribution process
Metadata and build checks are documented; review each skill's prerequisites before use.

Explore the CAT gallery ↗

Source: microsoft/cat-agent-skills · microsoft.github.io · external gallery

Contribution process and documented checks · GitHub ↗

Other capabilities · installation & integration

Add Skill is a plugin command for acquiring existing skills, not MCP setup. MCP servers documentation and Reconfigure setup/portability guidance are in Standards & Practices below; neither is runnable.

Rows = delivery boundaries · Columns = DISCOVER & AUTHOR → INSTALL SURFACES → CONNECT & INTEGRATE → VALIDATE & TEST. Purpose badges describe global lifecycle intent, not the column.

Delivery boundary	DISCOVER & AUTHOR	INSTALL SURFACES	CONNECT & INTEGRATE	VALIDATE & TEST
Host Environments CLI, IDE, and Cloud execution targets	—	Add Skill ↗ PLUGIN COMMAND: Acquire an existing skill from a local file or CAT gallery and optionally import it into a Copilot Studio CLI-agent workspace. Publishing is separate. Copilot Studio Plugin PLUGIN COMMAND	—	—

Supporting resources below and the external gallery remain visible across search and filters.

Reference

Standards & Practices — context that informs how you build (not installable skills; excluded from the skill count)

Where skills run

Supported host surfaces.

- CLI & terminal
Copilot CLI, Claude Code, Codex, Gemini CLI, OpenCode.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Deploy
- IDE & editor
VS Code, JetBrains, Cursor, Junie.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Deploy
- Cloud & hosted
Copilot cloud agent, code review, GitHub Copilot app.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Deploy

The Agent Skills standard

The open authoring format & packaging.

- SKILL.md
Reusable on-demand procedure with description and supporting resources.
Agent Skills · reference · Author
 - Agent Skills standard
Open format for instructions, scripts, and references.
 - Portable
Instructions, references, and standard skill structure.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Build
 - Plugin package
Distribute skills, agents, commands, hooks, and resources.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Deploy
 - Plugin extension
Verify hooks, commands, agents, and namespace behavior.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Migrate
 - Adapt
Filesystem paths, tool names, dynamic injection, invocation controls.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Migrate
- Portability: most pure SKILL.md procedures can travel across hosts that support Agent Skills. Adapt host-specific tools, paths, plugins, permissions and MCP configuration.
Agent Skills open standard · agentskills.io
GitHub Copilot host guidance · docs.github.com

Setup & governance

Prerequisites to run safely.

- Prerequisites
Install required runtimes and CLI versions.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Govern
- Authentication
Use approved identity and credential storage.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Govern
- Allowlisting
Limit tools, environments, and shell patterns.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Govern
- preferred environment
Resolve the correct target before deployment.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Govern
- MCP integration
Reconfigure server launch, auth, and permissions.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Migrate
- MCP servers
Live tool and data access beyond static instructions.
Model Context Protocol · reference · Reference
- Reconfigure
Authentication, allowlisting, server launch, and tenant access.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Guidance

Quality & safety practices

How to keep output trustworthy.

- Human review
Approve generated procedures, YAML, migration plans, and destructive actions.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Review
- Evals
Score descriptions, builders, fixtures, and repeatability.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Review
- Host test
Verify paths, tools, permissions, and feature extensions on each host.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Review
- Native tools
Prefer CLI/API/web tools over replaying recorded clicks.
Power Platform Skills · reference · Operate
- fallback tools
Select MCP, Dataverse CLI, Python SDK, or PAC by capability; raw Web API is a last resort.
Dataverse Skills · reference · Operate
- Well-Architected
Review workload design against five pillars.
Microsoft Learn · reference · Review

Microsoft Agent Framework

Framework guidance for agents and multi-agent workflows—not an Agent Skill.

Microsoft Learn · microsoft/agent-framework ↗

Build → Review pairings

- | | | | | | |
|--------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------|
| Capture expertise | Skill Recorder | → Review/edit generated SKILL.md | Portable procedure | Agent Skill | → Host smoke test |
| Live integration | MCP server/plugin | → Permissions + auth validation | Copilot Studio agent | mcs-assistant | → PAC validation + human review |

Daily decision rule

Treat plugins and MCP as integrations: verify the host, tools, authentication, permissions, and extension semantics every time.